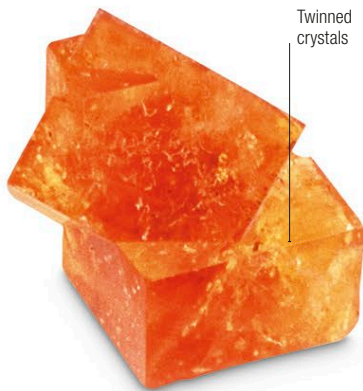


Colour



Twinned crystals

Interpenetrating crystals | These three striking orange fluorite crystals show a cubic structure, and demonstrate a typical pattern of twinning for this type of mineral.

Blue fluorescence



Fluorescent fluorite | The majority of fluorite fluoresces under ultraviolet light, as here, the colour of the fluorescence depending on the trace elements present.

Opalescent Art Deco glass by René Lalique and Louis Tiffany was produced using fluorite in the glass blend

Cut



Numerous facets in cushion cut

Cushion cut | The multi-faceted, round-cornered cut brings out the intense, deep green colouring of this large, 9.24-carat fluorite gemstone, found in the UK.

Multiple facet reflection



Brilliant cut | This brilliant cut demonstrates a high level of skill on the part of the faceter: multiple facet reflections are visible coming from the bottom half of the stone.

Pavilion facets



Cushion cut | The superbly executed cut of this oval, cushion-cut fluorite emphasizes reflections and hints of blue. Blue is a common colour in fluorite.

Settings



Colour zoning

Fluorite bead necklace | This necklace is composed of numerous circular, bi-convex beads of green and purple fluorite, many showing typical colour layering. Although fluorite is rarely used in jewellery as it fractures easily, it can be worn as beads.

Fluorite carvings

Use of massive fluorite

Fluorite with a massive habit – numerous intergrown crystals, rather than single ones – has been carved since ancient times. The ancient Egyptians used it for statues and scarabs, and Chinese artisans have carved fluorite for more than 300 years, recently making “New Age” items such as spheres and obelisks. Blue John, a massive English fluorite with layers of yellow and purple, has been carved since Roman times.



Fluorite bowl | The craftsmanship of this finely carved, layered bowl is evident in the thinness of its walls.